

DFCCIL

(DEDICATED FREIGHT CORRIDOR CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED.)

TRANSFORMING INDIA'S RAIL LOGISTICS - AN EXCLUSIVE CONVERSATION WITH SHRI PRAVEEN KUMAR, MANAGING DIRECTOR, DFCCIL



Shri Praveen Kumar
Managing Director
DFCCIL

India stands on the cusp of a logistics revolution–and at the very heart of this transformation is the Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL). From its ambitious inception to the near-completion of the vast Dedicated Freight Corridors, DFCCIL has not only reshaped the country's rail freight landscape but has also set new global benchmarks for scale, efficiency, and sustainability. Under the dynamic leadership of Managing Director Shri Praveen Kumar, the organization has accelerated project milestones, championed bold innovations, and carved a strategic vision that aligns with India's aspiration for a $5 trillion economy.

What does it take to drive such a colossal project to the finish line? How have groundbreaking technologies and green initiatives found their place alongside India's storied railway traditions? And what challenges and opportunities lie ahead as DFCCIL transitions from a construction behemoth into an operational powerhouse, guiding the future of the country's logistics for decades to come?

In this exclusive conversation, Shri Praveen Kumar decode DFCCIL's journey–its achievements, the hurdles overcome, and the path forward. Readers can expect a rare inside look at how leadership vision, relentless innovation, and a steadfast commitment to nation-building are converging to reshape India's supply chains and environmental ambitions. Discover how DFCCIL is unlocking economic growth, supporting 'Make in India', and laying the tracks for a greener, more competitive future. Join us as we delve into the fascinating story of India's premier freight corridors through the eyes of the leader steering this transformative journey.

Q: To begin, could you outline the genesis and mission of DFCCIL in transforming India's freight transportation landscape?

A. The Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL) was established with a central mission: to create world-class freight corridors that boost Indian Railways' modal share, provide efficient and economic logistics solutions, and drive national growth. The idea gained momentum as India recognized the pressing need for dedicated, high-capacity freight routes to decongest existing passenger lines and reduce logistics costs, which historically hovered around 14–15% of GDP — much higher than global standards. Our task was to build modern infrastructure that would seamlessly connect India's industrial, agricultural, and port hubs, propelling national and international trade forward.

Q: Can you share major milestones and achievements that DFCCIL has reached under your leadership?

A. We have made significant progress on both the Eastern and Western Dedicated Freight Corridors (EDFC and WDFC). As of July 2025, 96.4% of our targeted 2,843 route km network is operational, traversing 56 districts across seven states. Over this period, we successfully commissioned 1,272km